The Paralympics has grown from 400 athletes with a disability from 23 countries in 1960 to thousands of competitors from over 100 countries in the London 2012 Games. Paralympians strive for equal treatment with non-disabled Olympic athletes, but there is a large funding gap between Olympic and Paralympic athletes.

The Paralympic Games are organized in parallel with the Olympic Games, while the IOC-recognized Special Olympics World Games include athletes with intellectual disabilities, and the Deaflympics include deaf athletes.

The Paralympic games are designed to emphasize the participants' athletic achievement and not their disability. Recent games have proved that brilliantly. This is quite clear when we look at the number of participants-- around 3900 athletes from over 164 countries.

The first gold medalist for India in summer 2016 Paralympics is from Tamil Nadu. It is Mariappan Thangavelu who was born on 28 June 1995. In 2016 Rio De Jenerio Paralympics, Mariappan Thangavelu won the gold medal in the finals of men's high jump T42 category.

The following headings can be used.

- **Definition**
- **Origin**
- **Governed by**
- **Importance**
- **The Golden Man**
- **His achievement**

a) "Disability is a state of mind."

Here are a few Indians who have proved this statement right by excelling in various fields despite their disability and inspire us in so many ways every day.

Task: Identify them and write a short paragraph about each of the following achievers.

(These adjectives could help you: differently-abled, multi-talented, patient & persevering, determined, unswerving,)







Factual Description

Factual description is a description of a place, person, process or an object.

The following points are necessary for a factual description.

- The ideas should be systematically presented with important points first, followed by additional information.
- It should be simple, attractive and appealing; pay attention to detail and observation skills.
- The title should be short and catchy.

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